Fingerprint counts

Fingerprints Up Close

Name _____ Date _____

Show your thinking with numbers, marks, or words.

1. Little Wonderer counts 38 ridges on one print and 52 ridges on another. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the greater count (or the shared count if equal)?

38 ○ 52

Show your thinking.

2. Next, Big Wonderer presses 71 prints on one page and 67 prints on the next page. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the greater count (or the shared count if equal)?

71 ○ 67

Show your thinking.

3. The little one finds 45 pores on one strip of tape and 45 pores on another. Put >, <, or = in the circle. What is the greater count (or the shared count if equal)?

45 ○ 45

Show your thinking.

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4. The big one counts 34 ridge endings on a big drawing. What is 34 rounded to the nearest ten?

34 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

5. The little one draws 86 tiny pore dots. What is 86 rounded to the nearest ten?

86 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

6. The big one moves 65 wet marbles in a long game. What is 65 rounded to the nearest ten?

65 → nearest ten: ___

Show your thinking.

A hidden print

Tiny ridges carry sweat and oil. A touch copies their pattern, even when you cannot see it.

Three patterns

Loops curve back. Whorls make circles. Arches flow across with a bump. No two have ever been found to match.

Made before birth

Prints form before birth. Each fingertip grows in its own tiny way, so even twins differ.

Koala prints

Koalas and people both grip things. Scientists think ridges may help us feel fine textures.

A safe print lift

Detective tools are for trained lab workers. A pencil patch and clear tape make a safe print.

Wrinkly fingers

Nerves make bath fingers wrinkle. Maybe wrinkles help grip wet things. Scientists are still checking.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!

WONDER DAILY

Fingerprints Up Close

Explain a fingerprint clue in your words

Fingerprints Up Close · Curiosity day

Name _____ Date _____

Choose one picture. Say your idea first, then draw or write it.



Three patterns



Ridges up close



Wet marbles

Draw your own fingerprint big. Mark one place where a ridge ends or splits.

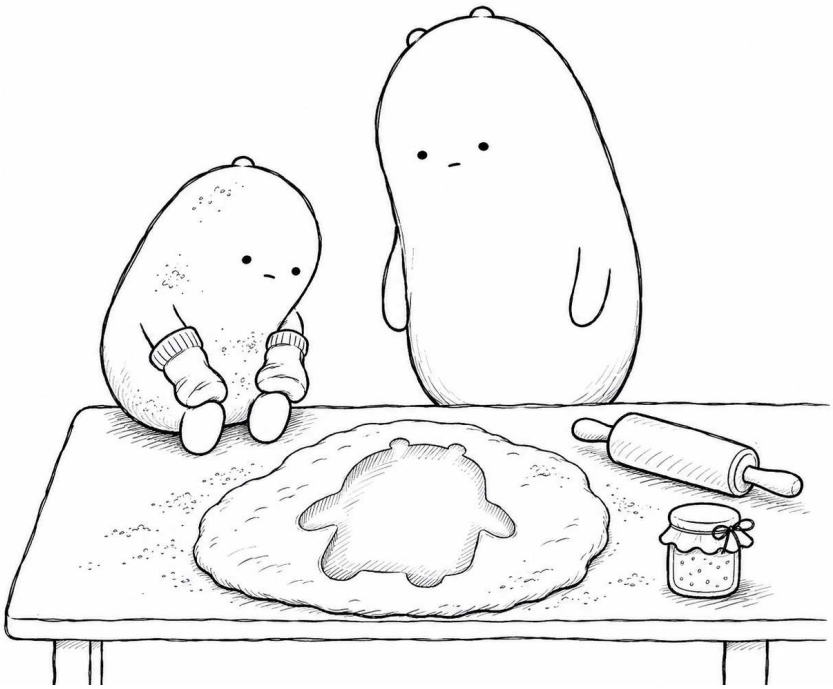
ridge · loop · whorl · arch · because · maybe

My print is a loop, whorl or arch because … how do the ridges flow?

Twins have different prints because … how does each fingertip grow?

Wrinkly fingers might help because … what might they grip?

Does your sentence tell what you noticed and use because or maybe to explain?



Little Wonderer Leaves Clues

Little Wonderer touched the jam jar lid,
the window, the doorknob, the drum. Yes, it did.
It patted the mirror, it poked at the cake,
it tapped every spoon just for tapping's sake.

"Oh no!" it cried out. "There are clues everywhere!
A loop on the cupboard! A whorl on the chair!
A detective could follow my trail through the house.
I'm as easy to find as a jam-covered mouse!"

Big Wonderer nodded and wiped off a pane.
"Your swirls will grow bigger but mostly remain.
No two have been found to match, pair after pair,
so a print is a clue that says someone was there."

So the little one wore socks on both hands all day,
to tiptoe through mischief and sneak right away.
But it tripped on the rug and it fell in the dough,
and now there's a Little-shaped print, head to toe.